

July 12, 2026

Clinical Feature Construction & Selection with Agentic AI

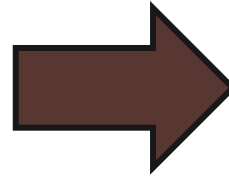
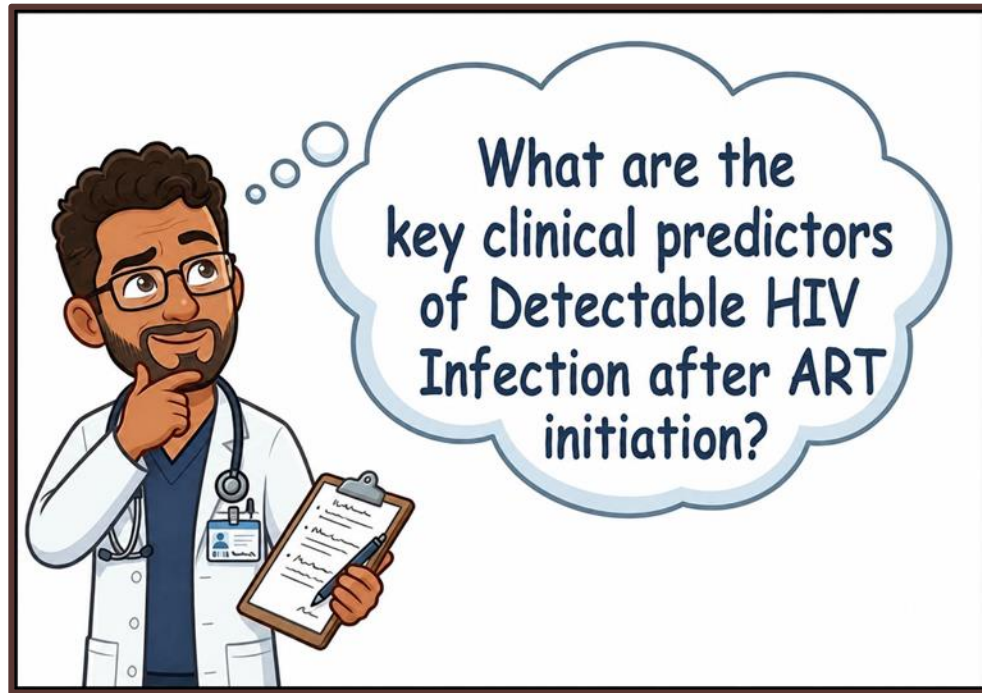
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Research Scientist I

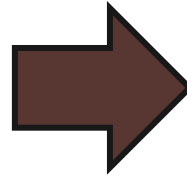
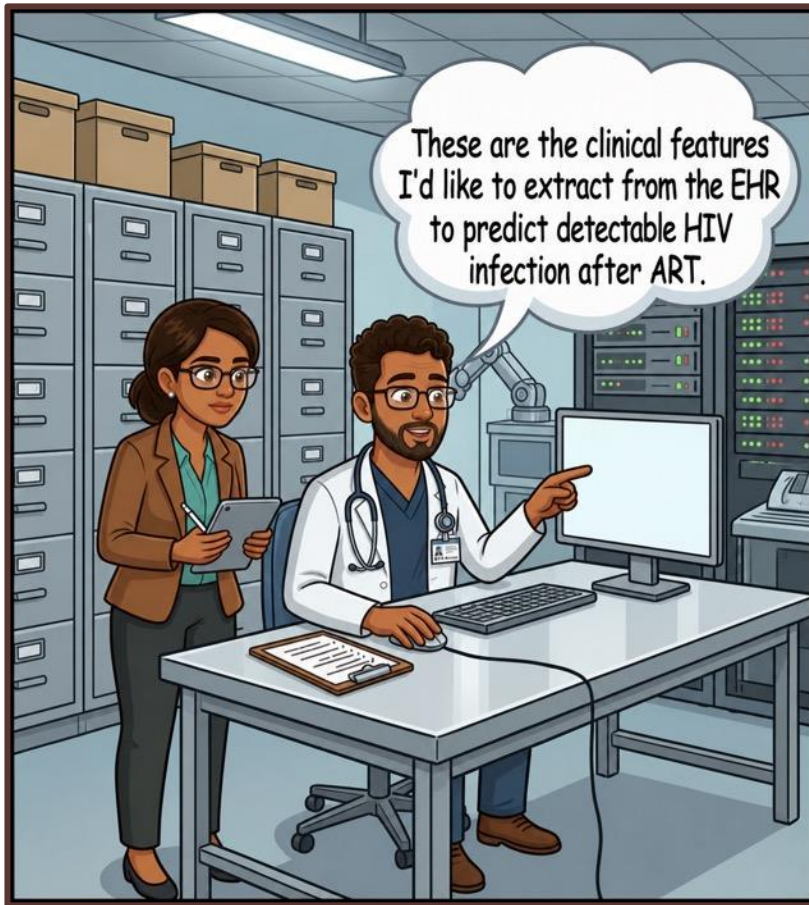
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Step 1: Develop a Hypothesis and Pull Data



Step 2: Feature Construction



[illegible]

Can Feature Construction be Fully Automated?

Goals

Produce a fully autonomous, agentic system to:

1. Identify, construct, and select relevant EHR features (ICD-10 codes, labs, medications, vitals, and demographics) predictive for a HIV viral load status (detectable vs undetectable)
2. Create a dataset for downstream predictive modeling

What we have at our disposal:

Knowledge – Curated Sources of Biomedical Knowledge

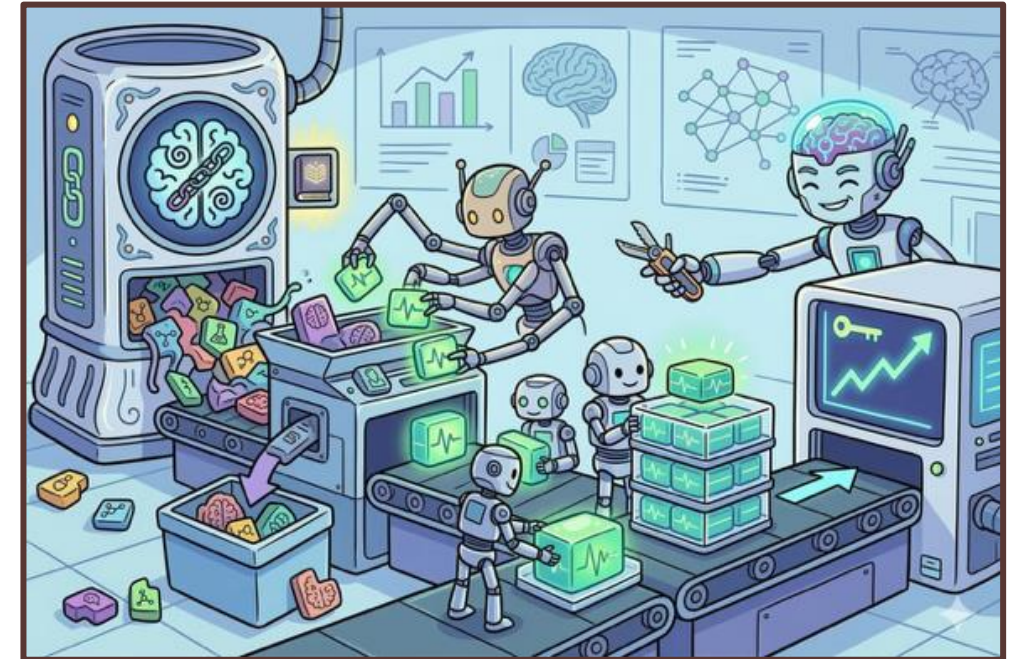
- AddictionKB: addiction, psychiatric comorbidity, and HIV knowledge base
- Summaries of 300+ relevant papers in Open Knowledge Format (OKF)

Inference Model

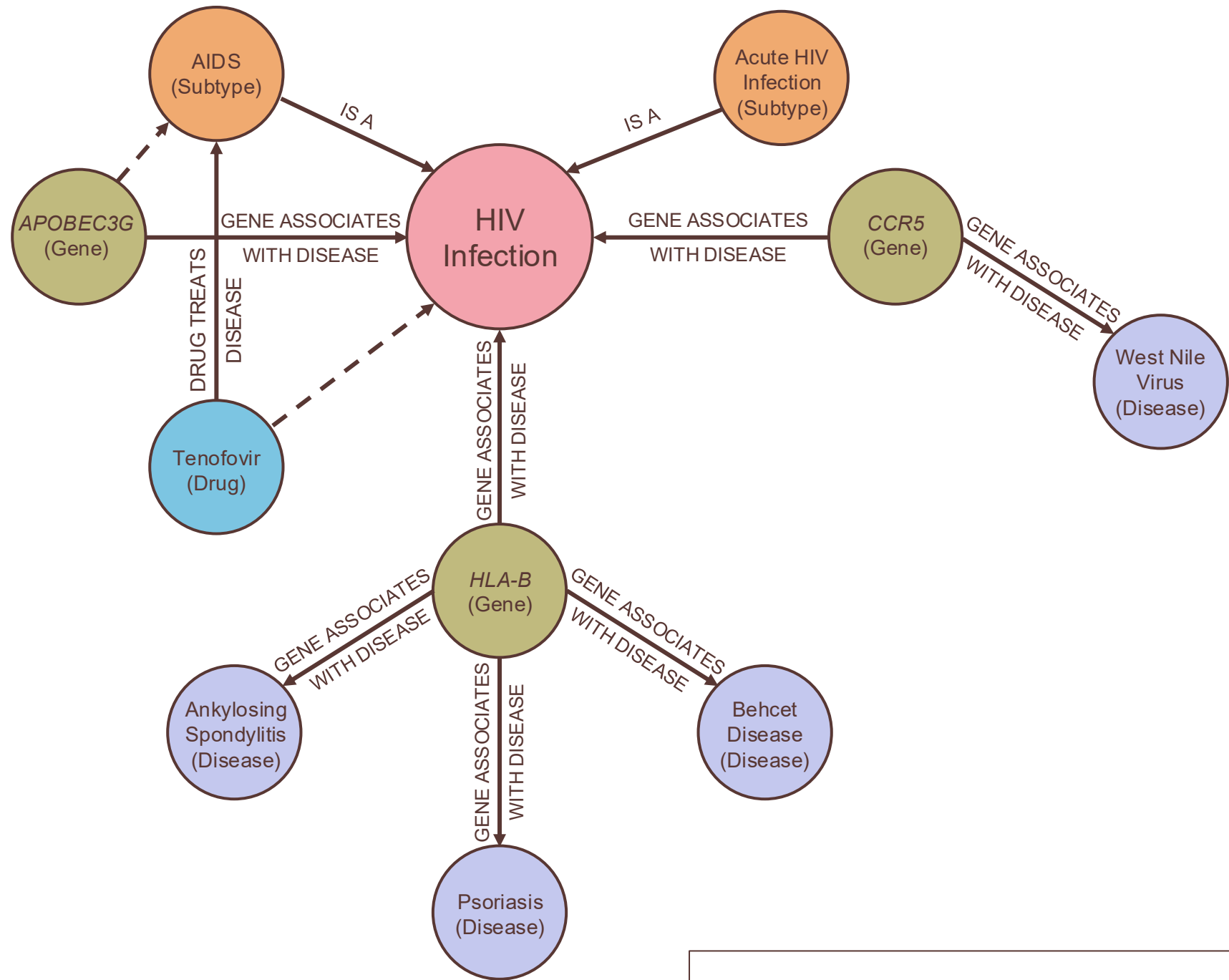
- Claude Sonnet 5

Tools

- Relevant software packages and scripts, including a semantic matcher
 - Semantic matcher aligns knowledge graph entities, OKF terms, and model inference entities (thoughts) to EHR data entities for proper feature construction



AddictionKB



Optimizing Your Party: The Value of Diverse Agentic Roles



The Agentic Feature Construction System



Autonomous Agents & Their Roles



Steps 1 & 7: Architect – Supervisor

- Initiates the linear agentic graph
- Makes final decisions on feature inclusion/exclusion for feature construction



Step 2: Scout – Knowledge Graph (KG) Explorer

- Traverses the KG for clinical relationships
 - 1 hop to n -hop traversal
- Performs link prediction to discover novel associations



Step 3: Sage – Literature Expert (OKF)

- Navigates relevant clinical knowledge (papers and abstracts) to identify potential features
- Uses the Open Knowledge Framework (OKF)



Step 4: Cleric – Clinician

- Decides what clinically relevant concepts are missing from the KG and OKF
- Uses expertise to suggest new features



Step 5: Inquisitor – Critic

- Critiques all features provided by agents 2-4 with internal knowledge
- Provides feedback and suggestions for inclusion/exclusion



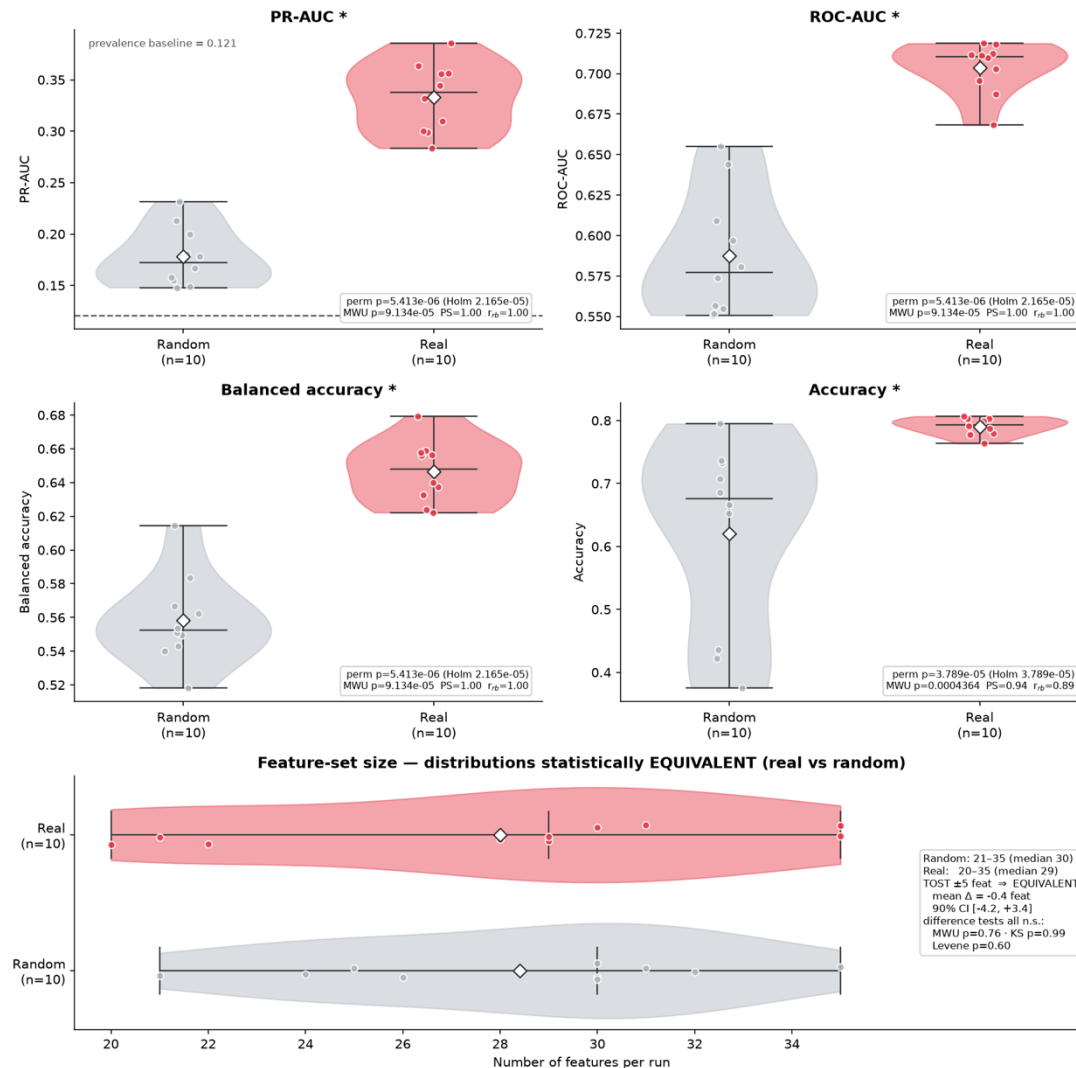
Step 6: Wizard – Statistician & Feature Selector

- Constructs all pending features in a temporary dataframe and performs unsupervised statistical analyses
 - Assesses missingness, variances, correlations, & prevalences
- Provides feedback and suggestions for inclusion/exclusion
- Loops back to Architect for final inclusion/exclusion decisions

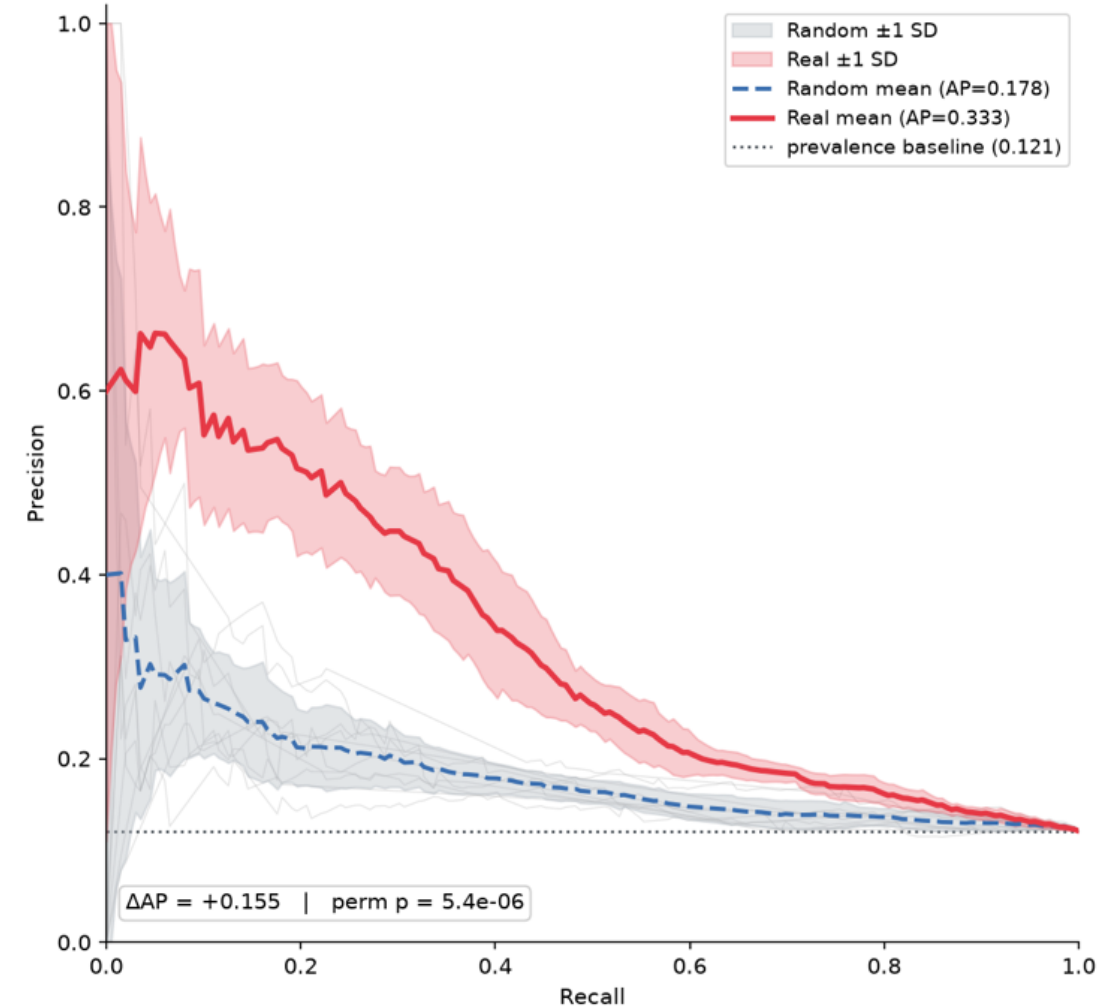


Results – Predictive Metric Comparisons to Random

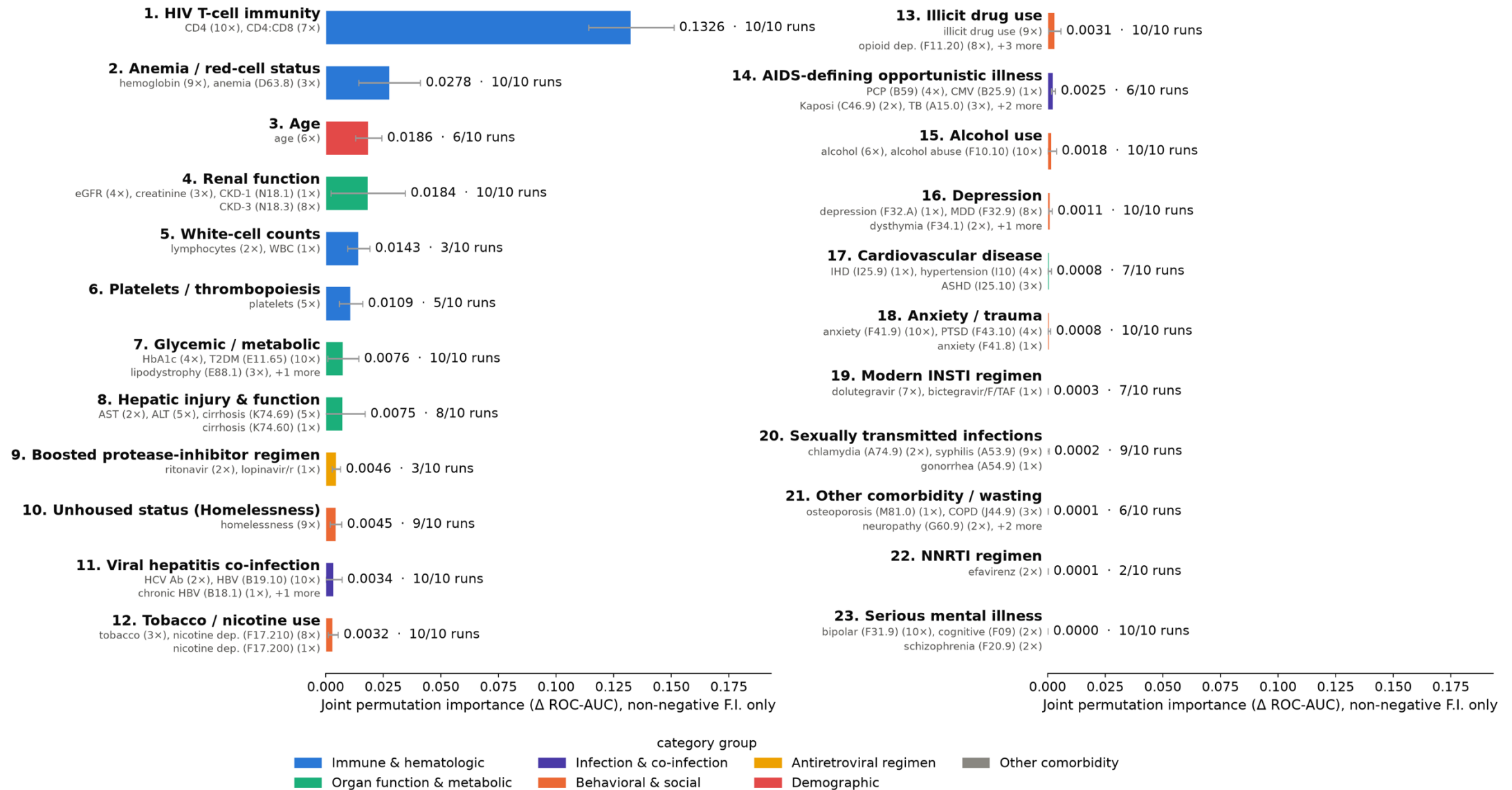
Agentic features vs. random baseline features (same seed [42] split)



Precision-Recall: Agentic Features vs Random Baseline Features



Results – Aggregate Feature Importance by Clinical Category



Future Agents & Architectural Improvements

1. Human-in-the-Loop



2. Complex Graph and Looping Topologies



3. Topology/LLM Optimization with Evolutionary Algorithms



4. Expansion Pack Agents



Paladin – Optimization and QA

- Optimizes pipeline hyperparameters/topology
- Assess tool use and code quality



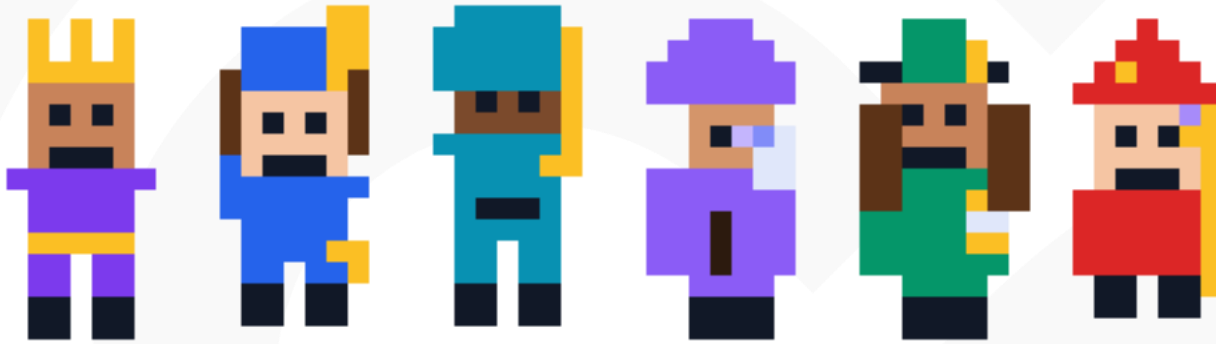
Justicar – AI Fairness/Replicability

- Assesses feature/cohort bias/fairness
- Suggests alternative sampling/features
- Tests pipeline replicability

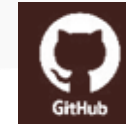


Farseer – Feature Engineering

- Creates new meta features using logical operators or by clinical insight via OKF/KG



philipfreda.com



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